

Module 5.2 Assignment

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CSD340

Style Guide: Design Direction

Design Concept: Garden, Growth & Family

My visual design for this biosite draws inspiration from her love of gardening home projects, family, and the PNW. The site will use bright, natural color palette with warm neutrals, garden greens, and floral accents.

Visual Keywords: Natural, Bright, Warm, Welcoming, Organic, Personal

Design Principles:

Natural: Colors and imagery should feel connected to plants, flowers, and outdoors

Warm: Site should feel personal and inviting, not overly formal

Balanced: Generous whitespace so that floral colors and photos don't overwhelm

Personal: I want the site to feel like a story about Heather, not just a generic gardening website.

Style Guide: Color Palette

Primary: Garden Green #3F5D3A	Headings, navigation, primary accents
Secondary: Sage	Secondary accents/background
Accent: Sunflower	Highlights, buttons, decorative accents
Accent: Zinnia Pink	Floral accent
Accent: Terracotta	Secondary accent
Primary: Warm Cream	Primary Background
Secondary: Deep Brown	Body Text

Style Guide: Typography

Element	Font	Weight	Purpose
H1	Playfair Display	700	Page title
H2	Playfair Display	600	Major sections
H3	Playfair Display	600	Image/card titles
Body	Lato	400	Main Content
Navigation	Lato	700	Navigation
Captions	Lato	400	Supporting text
Buttons	Lato	700	Calls to action

Style Guide: Links & Buttons

Navigation	Primary Button	External Link
Default: Garden Green Hover: Terracotta Active Page: <u>Garden Green + underline</u>	Background: Garden Green Text: Warm Cream Border: none Corners: slightly rounded Hover: Terracotta	Hover: <u>Terracotta + underline</u>

Style Guide: Images & Content Cards

Image Treatment:

- Rounded corners
- No heavy borders
- Let original photo provide color

Image Captions:

- Short title
- 50-80 word story/caption

Style Guide: Layout & Spacing

Page Width

- Maximum content width about 1200px

Page margins

- Desktop: 60-80px
- Mobile: 24px

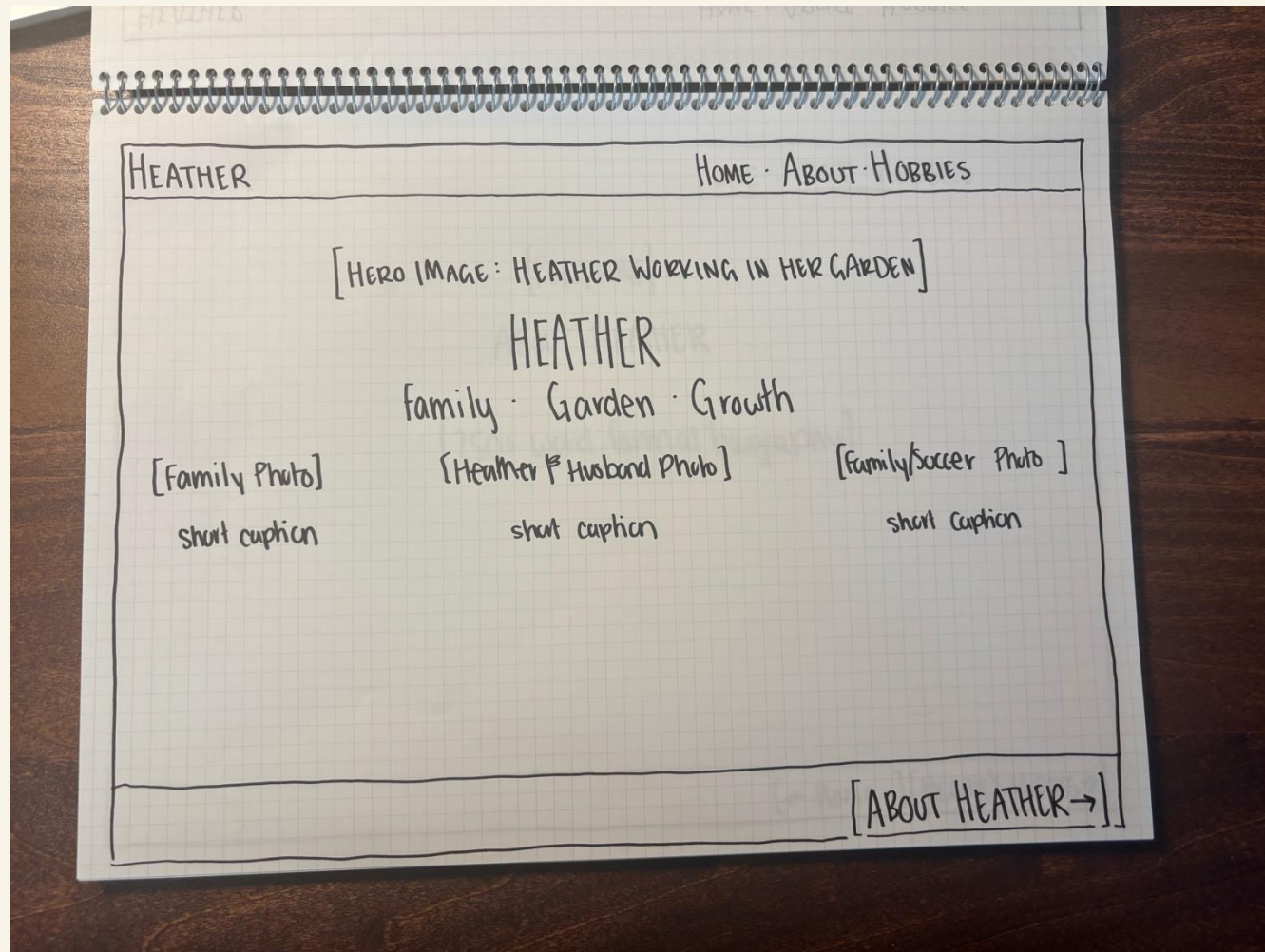
Section spacing

- Between major sections: 64-96px
- Between image and caption: 16px

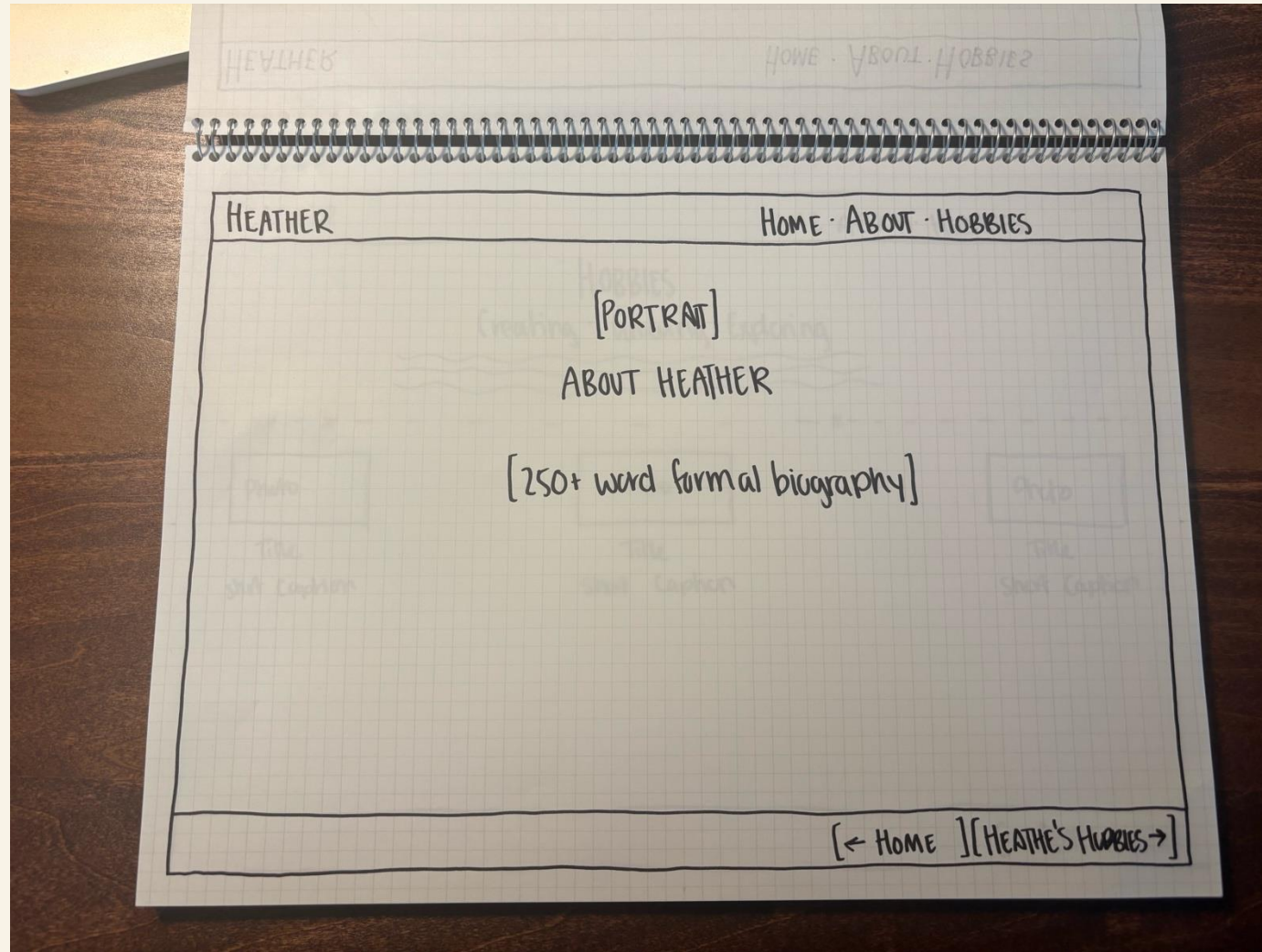
Text Width

- About 700-800px

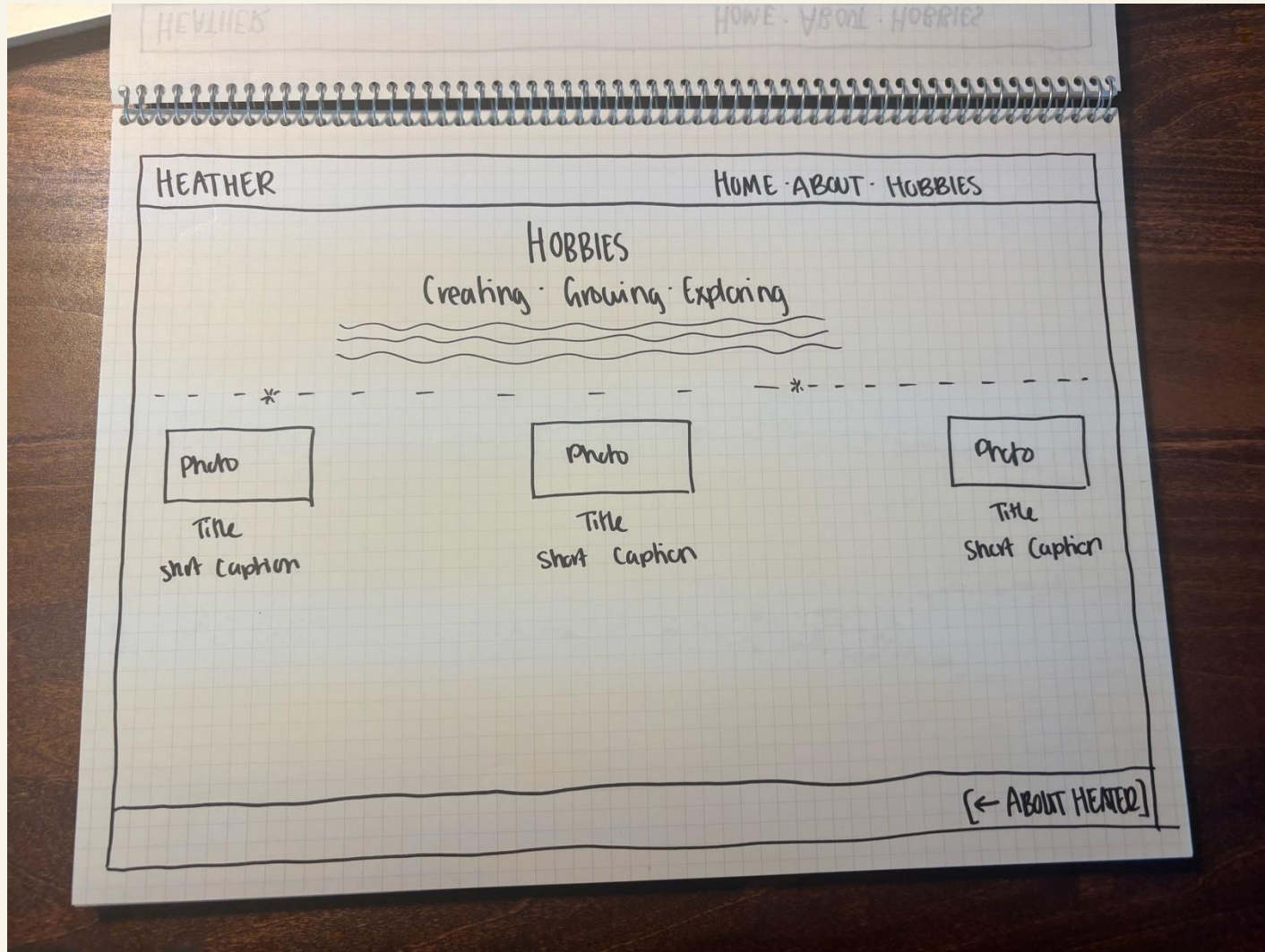
Wireframe: Landing page



Wireframe: About page



Wireframe: Hobbies page



Interview Questions: Get to know you

1. How would you describe yourself to someone who has never met you?

Seattle born and raised, which means I genuinely like rain, think fall is the superior season, and have strong feelings about coffee and trees. I'm a realist, opinionated, and direct to a fault. Family and friends would call me passionate, fiercely loyal, and generous. Give me a flower garden to putter in, bees to obsess over, music that inspires dancing, and a quality bottle of wine, and I'm golden. I believe in the power of plants, energy in the air, and mindfulness. Surround me with people who laugh at themselves, share their thoughts, and are open to a better way, and my cup will be full.

Interview Questions: Get to know you

Q: What are some things that are most important to you in daily life?

Coffee is non-negotiable. I prefer slow mornings, ideally accompanied by a symphony of songbirds or the patter of rain outside and bossa nova music playing inside. Midday is when I hit my stride, and having an enthralling audiobook downloaded and my AirPods charged is essential equipment. I'm driven by the satisfaction of a productive day—whether I've made progress on a renovation project, have a thick layer of garden dirt under my nails, or conquered a robust to-do list. Strategic breaks for tasty snacks and herbal tea keep the operation running smoothly. And at the end of the day, walking into a clean kitchen and unwinding over conversation with my spouse (and favorite person in the world) bring me an unreasonable amount of satisfaction.

Interview Questions: Get to know you

Q: What is something you've accomplished or worked on that you're particularly proud of?

I'm particularly proud of completing both my BS and MBA degrees in my 30's, while raising children and moving around the country. The degrees themselves matter to me, but what I'm most proud of is what earning them represents. I want my children and family to understand the value of education, hard work, and creating opportunities for themselves. More than anything, I hope I show them every day that a thriving life can be built through their own effort, resilience, and willingness to keep moving forward—even when life is challenging. I want to demonstrate that it's never too late to change direction, start something new, or simply change your mind about what you want your life to look like.

Interview Questions: Gardening & Projects

Q: How did you first become interesting in gardening and planting?

My interest in gardening really came out of need. I had plenty of childhood experience staining white sneakers green from mowing the lawn, but no gardening. In 2011, we moved our small family to Portland and rented a house with a large yard consisting mostly of dirt and bark. I was working full time and going to school at night and needed a stress-free space to decompress on the weekends. I started daydreaming about sitting on the back porch with a cup of coffee surrounded by flowers. I began paying attention to what surrounding neighbors were growing in their yards and spending Saturday mornings wandering the local nursery. My first real project was building raised garden beds and rather haphazardly sowing seeds. It was hard work, very dirty, and I had little idea what I was doing—but the moment those first green sprouts pushed through the soil, I was hooked. That summer I grew dahlias and a modest supply of cucumbers, green beans, and carrots, and filled the porch with pots of annual flowers. Since then, every property we've moved to has felt like a fresh canvas and a new opportunity to experiment, learn, and create something beautiful.

Interview Questions: Gardening & Projects

Q: What is your favorite type of plant or flower to grow and why?

Growing flowers from seed is the most gratifying for me, especially zinnias. There's something incredibly satisfying about watching a tiny seed go through every stage of growth and eventually produce an abundance of colorful blooms. I've also found that the plants I start myself tend to be healthier and more prolific than anything I bring home from the nursery. I'm equally drawn to plants that earn their keep—lavender, rosemary, echinacea, chamomile, and herbs that are beautiful in the garden but also have medicinal or culinary uses, and naturally keep away pests. I love a plant that can multitask.

Interview Questions: Gardening & Projects

Q: What is your favorite gardening or planning project that you've worked on?

My favorite gardening project began in 2017, when we bought a 1936 Cape Cod fixer-upper on a half-acre hillside just outside Seattle. The property was completely overgrown with ivy, blackberry bushes, and weeds, and we initially considered bringing in a bulldozer and starting over. Thankfully, we didn't. As we slowly cleared different pockets of the property, we began uncovering a treasure trove of ornamental trees, perennial flowers, garden art, and even an outdoor fireplace with a 30-gallon cast-iron cauldron. What looked like an unruly mess simply needed someone willing to uncover, prune, and nurture what was already there. We later learned that decades earlier, a design architect had renovated the property and meticulously created themed garden areas that flowed together into a park-like setting. Bringing that forgotten garden back to life became less about creating something new and more about discovering and honoring what someone else had lovingly created years before. It was a lot of work, but also a bit like a horticultural treasure hunt.

Interview Questions: Gardening & Projects

Q: Is there a gardening project or plant that you would like to try in the future?

I'd love to create wildlife-friendly hedgerows around our property. We recently moved farther out of the city and are surrounded by an abundance of wildlife, so I love the idea of designing something that serves multiple purposes—an intentional, natural barrier that's beautiful to look at while providing food, shelter, and habitat. I envision a layered mix of native trees, shrubs, grasses, and flowering plants that changes with the seasons and gives the birds, bees, and other wildlife a place to thrive. Beautiful, functional, and a little wild is my ideal garden.

Interview Questions: Family & Memories

Q: What is one of your favorite memories with your siblings?

I love having a lot of siblings—it's rarely boring. We're a good mix of extroverts and introverts, but we all share a wry sense of humor and enough silliness to guarantee a lot of laughter when we're together. These days we're scattered across Washington, Oregon, and Idaho, but Seattle will always feel like home to all of us.

One of my favorite memories is coming together for our mom's 70th birthday in the summer of 2021. Her favorite flowers are zinnias, and since they bloom around her July birthday, we scattered several hundred zinnia seeds throughout my yard that spring. By the time her party arrived, the yard had transformed into a glorious garden of colorful blooms. Having my siblings together, celebrating our mom surrounded by flowers we had grown especially for her, made it one of those wonderfully simple memories that sticks with you.

Interview Questions: Family & Memories

Q: What is a recent family adventure or experience that you really enjoyed?

We've been fortunate to travel with our three older children over the years, but our youngest wasn't quite ready for international travel until recently. During a break from work and college life, we managed to pull her away from her hectic schedule and introduce her to one of our favorite places—the Riviera Maya in Mexico. I loved getting to experience the warmth of the people, culture, and history through her eyes. We found the perfect balance of rest and adventure: relaxing under the palm trees and soaking in the scents and sounds of the tropics, then hiking the Tulum ruins and exploring the jungle. Getting to finally share a place we love with her made the trip especially memorable.

Interview Questions: Family & Memories

Q: What is something you enjoy most about spending time with our family?

What I enjoy most is experiencing the world through my children's eyes. They're intelligent, creative, dynamic humans who see the world so differently than I did at their age. Whether we're grabbing a quick lunch or spending a long afternoon cooking and listening to music, I catch little glimpses of my spouse and me in their expressions, mannerisms, and humor. But then they speak, and I'm reminded how wonderfully individual they each are. Watching them become entirely their own people—and genuinely enjoying who those people are—is one of my favorite parts of being their mom.

Bonus Question

Q: Is there a website, blog, or online resource that you enjoy using for gardening, home design, or another hobby? What do you like about it?

It's a toss-up between YouTube and ChatGPT. I firmly believe that if I've run into a challenge, chances are someone else has already tackled it—and probably posted a video about it. There's tremendous value in learning from other people's experience, and I especially enjoy seeing real people share what worked, what didn't, and the tricks they learned along the way.

ChatGPT appeals to a different side of me. It puts an enormous range of knowledge and tools at my fingertips, and as a straight shooter, I appreciate being able to tailor the conversation to how I like to communicate. It also lets me do things I'd otherwise need several different applications—and a lot of tutorials—to accomplish. I use it for everything from visualizing paint colors in a room to researching plants and plotting out a garden bed.

Favorite youtuber: https://www.youtube.com/@elyse_myers

Biography:

- Born and raised in Seattle, Heather has always had a strong connection to the Pacific Northwest. She describes herself as a realist who is passionate, direct, fiercely loyal, and always willing to look for a better way of doing things. Family and friends know her for her generosity, sense of humor, and enthusiasm for the things she loves. From music and coffee to gardening and spending time with the people closest to her.
- Family has remained one of the most important parts of Heather's life. As a mother, she especially enjoys watching her children grow into independent, creative individuals. She loves experiencing the world through their perspectives and appreciates both the similarities they share with her and the qualities that make each of them unique. Her relationship with her siblings is equally important. Although they now live throughout Washington, Oregon, and Idaho, they continue to come together to celebrate their family and create new memories.

Biography continued:

- Heather's interest in gardening began after moving to Portland in 2011. While working full time and attending school at night, she was looking for a peaceful way to spend her weekends. A yard that was mostly dirt and bark became an opportunity to create the flower-filled outdoor space she had imagined. Her first raised garden beds were an experiment but watching the first seedlings emerge from the soil sparked an interest that has continued ever since. Today, she especially enjoys growing flowers from seed, with zinnias among her favorites, as well as plants that combine beauty with practical uses.
- One of Heather's most meaningful gardening projects began in 2017, when her family purchased an overgrown 1936 Cape Cod home outside Seattle. What initially appeared to be an unruly property turned out to contain decades of carefully designed gardens, ornamental trees, perennial flowers, and unique garden features. Restoring the property became a process of uncovering and nurturing what was already there rather than simply starting over. For Heather, gardening is not only about creating something beautiful but also about discovering possibilities in what already exists.

Biography continued:

- Her dedication to learning extends beyond gardening. Heather completed both her bachelor's and master's degrees in her thirties while raising children and moving around the country. For her, those accomplishments represent more than education; they demonstrate the importance of hard work, resilience, and the willingness to change direction. She hopes her family sees through her example that it is never too late to learn something new, pursue a different path, or create a life that feels meaningful.
- Whether she is tending a garden, working on a home project, spending time with family, or learning something new, Heather approaches life with curiosity and purpose. She values creativity, growth, and the simple satisfaction of making something a little better than she found it.

Photos: Hobbies



Gardening started as a way for Heather to create a peaceful space to escape the demands of work and school. What began with a few raised beds and a handful of seeds eventually became one of her favorite ways to spend her time. For Heather, every garden is a new opportunity to experiment, learn, and create something beautiful.



Heather especially enjoys growing flowers from seed, with zinnias among her favorites. She loves watching a tiny seed develop through every stage of growth before eventually producing an abundance of colorful blooms. She is also drawn to plants that can do more than simply look beautiful, such as lavender, rosemary, echinacea, chamomile, and other useful herbs.



Heather's approach to gardening isn't always about starting from scratch. Restoring a property can become a kind of horticultural treasure hunt. It's about uncovering what was already there and giving it the care it needed to thrive again.

Photos: Personal



Family is one of the most important parts of Heather's life. She grew up with several siblings and describes their family dynamic as a mix of different personalities, plenty of humor, and a little silliness. Although her siblings are now spread across Washington, Oregon, and Idaho, spending time together remains something she deeply values.



Sometimes the best family memories come from simple gatherings. This photo captures Heather spending time with her family at a soccer game. With her children together in one place, moments like this reflect something Heather values most: having the opportunity to spend time with the people she loves and enjoy each other's company.



Heather and her husband have shared many adventures together, including exploring the outdoors and traveling to places they enjoy. She values experiences that give them an opportunity to slow down, explore, and appreciate their surroundings. Whether they're discovering somewhere new or simply enjoying time together, these shared experiences are an important part of their life together.

Photo: Portrait

- Heather is a Seattle native with a love for family, gardening, home projects, and learning new things. She finds satisfaction in productive days, whether that means getting her hands dirty in the garden, making progress on a renovation, or checking something off a long to-do list. At the center of it all are the people and experiences that make life meaningful to her.



Photo: Landing

